Pout Chop Jal

Strategy, climate finance and policy research

poutchopj@gmail.com +233 59 430 3507
linkedin.com/in/pout-chop-jal
my-portfolio-pout-chop.vercel.app
Accra, Ghana

Profile

Founder of Carbon Clarity and Ashesi University Business Administration graduate (Mastercard Foundation Scholar). I turn field research and policy gaps into practical systems for climate finance and mobility in Africa, with two competition wins and a Sector Impact Award in 2026.

Experience

Founder & CEO, Carbon Clarity
Nov 2025 – present

Accra, Ghana

- Won 1st place and a $2,000 prize (Team 7) at the ALA & IOM UN Migration Equity and Carbon Inclusion Hackathon with a transparency system for carbon finance in IOM Mozambique's cookstove programme: 2,770 stoves across 9 resettlement sites.
- Designed the benefit-sharing formula, itemized picture receipts, village price boards and a household guide in Emakhuwa, Portuguese and English; tested with 50 household representatives at 3 sites. IOM and Bridge Carbon are reviewing the concept.
- Leading a fish-smoking stove and carbon credit study in James Town, Accra, under Nkabom Research Projects; baseline fieldwork completed Oct 2026.

Data Specialist and Research Intern, Graduate Guidance Group (G3 Africa)
Apr 2026 – present

Remote

- Audited and corrected 54 country profiles in a master policy matrix on student mobility and visas.
- Quantified a 150% visa cost gap between standard international students and EAC scholars, used in two policy advocacy proposals.
- Designed a standard visa barrier system for 18 countries, cutting intake assessment time by 35%.

Technical Assistant, Nkabom Collaborative
Current

Office of the Provost, Ashesi University

- Support Nkabom Research Projects, including Carbon Clarity's James Town fieldwork.

Market Manager, Yamalé
Current

Remote. AI legal research platform for 55 African jurisdictions

Case Study Researcher, Microsoft × Ashesi Future Builders
Feb – Apr 2026

AI Skilling Program, Accra

- Co-designed Accra-Flow, an AI framework that gives full trotros priority at Accra's intersections, with a pilot plan for the N4 corridor. Team named winner of the case competition.

Entry Evaluation Panelist & Judge, Royal Commonwealth Society
May 2026 – present

The Queen's Commonwealth Writing Competition, Nordic-Baltic Hub

- Judged entries in a record year of 53,840 submissions from all 56 Commonwealth countries.

Earlier
2023 – 2025

- Virtual Intern, Excelerate (Rochester Institute of Technology): AI prompt design, content and campaign work.
- Business Development and Sales Intern, Thematic: music industry market research.

Education

BSc Business Administration
Ashesi University, Ghana, 2022 – 2026
Mastercard Foundation Scholar

Thesis: Service quality and loyalty in rural mobile money. 17 interviews in Berekuso; introduced "Strategic Multi-homing". Supervisor: Dr. Josephine Djan.

D-Lab member, Robotics Experience mentor, Berekuso Math tutor

Honors

Winner, Microsoft × Ashesi Future Builders case competition
Oct 2026

Sector Impact Award, AL for Infrastructure
Africa Career Networks, Johannesburg, Aug 2026

1st place, ALA & IOM Carbon Inclusion Hackathon
Feb 2026

Certificate of Appreciation, judge
Royal Commonwealth Society, 2026

Certifications

Agile Project Management
PMI, 2026

AI-Integrated Leadership
Aspire Institute with Adobe, 2025

Career readiness mentorship
Global Mentorship Initiative, 2026

Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
IBM, 2023

Lean Six Sigma White Belt
2023

Skills

Carbon markets & dMRV · Benefit-sharing design · Policy research · Qualitative interviews · SERVQUAL · Budgeting & financial models · Stakeholder partnerships · Data cleaning & analysis · Project management

Languages

English, Arabic, Nuer